O'NEILL
PROPERTY

BRAND GUIDELINES
EDITION TWO

Property is personal.

One standard, from the first appraisal to the last signature. This document is what makes a board, a listing, a card and the website look like they came from the same agency.

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Contents

01 **The brand** P.03
Overview, promise, audience, the nine rules

02 **The mark** P.04
Lockups, clear space, size, colourways, misuse

03 **Colour** P.05
The four values, their proportions, approved text pairs

04 **Type** P.06
The two families, the scale, how to set them

05 **Voice** P.07–08
Tone, on brand vs off brand, the word book

06 **Signage and print** P.09
Boards, cards, stock, finish

07 **Photography** P.10
What a shoot must and must not do

08 **Website and digital** P.11
Build spec and known fixes

09 **Quick reference** P.12
The one page to check before anything goes out

10 **Open decisions and contact** P.13

The brand

O’Neill Property is an independent Gold Coast agency built on the O’Neill name, not a franchise template with a local name added to it. The standard has to hold from the first appraisal to the last signature, because it is the family’s name on the board.

THE PROMISE

Listen first, give the straight version, and run the campaign properly to the end.

WHO IT IS FOR

Owners and buyers on the Gold Coast, from a first apartment to a home on the water. The same standard at every price point.

WHAT IT IS NOT

A franchise template, an exclusive boutique, or a brand that changes when someone edits someone else’s.

Flag: Edition One scoped this to “Northern Gold Coast” specifically. Confirm whether the service area is Northern Gold Coast or Gold Coast-wide before this goes to print, this word choice runs through audience copy, SEO and imagery selection.

BRAND PERSONALITY, IN EIGHT WORDS

Confident · Personal · Premium · Clear
Knowledgeable · Warm · Results-focused · Local

NEVER

Boastful · Over-familiar · Pretentious · Abrupt · Jargon-heavy · Fluffy · Salesy · Parochial

The nine rules, if nothing else is read

01 **Say:** “Property is personal.” Confident, warm, specific, never salesy.

02 **Show:** natural light. Architectural, uncluttered, honest colour.

03 **Set in:** Sinhala MN and Inter. Two families, never a third.

04 **Build on:** Sage Grey. Half of everything. Basalt for type, Stone to rest the eye.

05 **Lead with:** the O’Neill mark, always dominant, always with its clear space.

06 **Campaign in:** Own It, Preparing It, Sold It, Lease It, paired with the plain word wherever status must be instant.

07 **Protect:** whitespace. If it feels empty, it is probably right.

08 **Never:** gold, gradients or clichés. Premium comes from restraint, not decoration.

09 **Test with:** is the property the hero? If the answer is the agency, start again.

The mark

Three lockups, no fourth:

Primary

Wordmark over PROPERTY. Default for boards, covers, stationery, the site header.

MINIMUM 40 MM / 150 PX WIDE

Secondary

Wordmark alone. For tight horizontal bands: email footers, ad bars, vehicle livery, sponsor rows.

MINIMUM 28 MM / 110 PX

Icon

The O and N monogram. Avatars, favicons, stamps, watermarks, or anywhere the full name already appears nearby.

MINIMUM 8 MM / 32 PX

Clear space



The cap height of the O, on every side, on all three lockups. Nothing enters it: type, rules, a photo edge, another logo, a portal badge. On a vehicle or fascia, measure from the physical panel edge, not the artwork box.

Four colourways, chosen for contrast, never a fifth

Basalt on light — the default, any Stone, paper or pale ground

Stone on Basalt — dark grounds, night photography, footers

Basalt on Stone — print, stationery, card-weight pieces

Sage Grey on Basalt — the social avatar, where full Stone reads too stark

Over photography: use Stone, place it on the quietest part of the frame, or put it on a solid band beside the picture. Never a drop shadow.

Six things never to do to it

Don’t stretch it (scale both axes together), rotate it, recolour it (gold is the one colour this brand was built to avoid), add shadows or effects, fade it below full opacity (use the Sage colourway instead), or crop, box or draw a rule around it. Also: never sit Sage Grey type on a Sage Grey ground, the two greens measure 1.6:1 and the mark disappears.

Supplied as SVG. Always use the supplied artwork, unmodified.

Colour

Four values. Sage Grey is the ground the brand is built on, not an accent on a white one.



Sage Grey	#B7C1B3	Signature field: boards, covers, campaign panels, stationery	50%
Basalt	#3A3A3A	Anchor: all type, frames, fascias, footers	30%
Stone	#E2DAD1	Neutral: long-reading ground, mark reversed out of dark photography	15%
Deep Sage	#839C83	Graphic only: rules, markers, icon strokes. Never carries text	5%

Hex values come from the master artwork, never a screenshot. Stone should usually be the paper stock, not an ink.

Approved text pairs

WCAG 2.1 · body copy needs 4.5:1, large text needs 3:1

Sage Grey on Basalt	6.1:1	ALL TEXT
Basalt on Sage Grey	6.1:1	ALL TEXT
Basalt on Stone	8.2:1	ALL TEXT
Stone on Basalt	8.2:1	ALL TEXT
Deep Sage on Stone	2.2:1	DO NOT SET
Stone on Sage Grey	1.3:1	DO NOT SET

The one rule that matters most: no sage, Grey or Deep Sage, ever carries body copy. If words have to be read, set them in Basalt, or set them on Basalt.

Type

Two families, never a third.

Aa

Sinhala MN — display

Headlines, campaign statements, board addresses. One weight, never below 18 px, otherwise its contrast breaks down. Apple-only: a restrained high-contrast serif substitute and a CSS fallback still need to be nominated before launch (see Open decisions).

Aa

Inter — text

Everything that has to work: body copy, navigation, agent details, captions, forms, signage information. Weights 300, 400, 500, 600. Nothing heavier.

DISPLAY SINHALA MN · 64/.95	Property is personal
HEADING SINHALA MN · 44/1.15	A considered approach
SUBHEAD SINHALA MN · 28/1.25	Northern Gold Coast
EYEBROW INTER 600 · 11/.24EM, TRACKED	RECENT RESULTS
BODY LARGE INTER 300 · 19/1.7	A rare north-facing residence on a quiet Hope Island street
BODY INTER 400 · 16/1.75	Four bedrooms and direct boating access from a private pontoon
CAPTION INTER 500 · 12/.12EM, TRACKED	4 BED · 3 BATH · 2 CAR · 812 M²

Setting rules: one display size per layout, two headline sizes read as a template. Measure to about 65 characters. Never justify, hyphenate or track body copy. Capitals are reserved for lockups, eyebrows and captions, never a paragraph. A headline over three lines is too long.

Voice

An agent speaking, not a brochure. Knowledgeable, warm, decisive, brief. Lead with what matters to the client, prefer a specific fact to an inflated adjective. Australian English throughout, no dash used as punctuation, no exclamation marks.

ON BRAND

“North facing, 812 m², and the only home on the street with a private pontoon. We think it sells in three weeks.”

OFF BRAND

~~*“An absolutely breathtaking, once in a lifetime masterpiece that will take your breath away. A true must see!”*~~

By situation

Price reduction
Direct and unapologetic.

Missed result
Honest, brief, forward-looking.

Market commentary
Plain, useful, unspun.

Complaint
Human first, process second.

Words to avoid on principle

~~*breathtaking*~~ ~~*stunning*~~ ~~*must see*~~ ~~*dream home*~~ ~~*rare gem*~~ ~~*wow factor*~~ ~~*once in a lifetime*~~

If a line could describe any agency’s listing without changing a fact, rewrite it.

The word book

A consistent vocabulary costs nothing to print and makes every touchpoint recognisably O'Neill. The branded term is a device, not a replacement, run it beside the plain word wherever status must be instant (a portal, a footpath, a legal notice).

INSTEAD OF	O'NEILL SAYS	WHY
For Sale	**Own It**	*Hero campaign device, use it selectively*
Coming Soon	**Preparing It**	*Pre-market and soft launch*
Sold	**Sold It**	*Corrected from "Achieved" in Edition One, see note below*
For Lease	**Lease It**	*Rental campaign device*
Open Home	**Open**	*The date and time are the hero, not the label*
Listing	**Property, Residence or Home**	*By context*
Key Features	**The Details**	*Editorial, less generic*
Recent Sales	**Recent Results**	*Preferred on collateral*
Vendor	**Seller**	*Client-facing language, not industry language*
Buyer database	**Buyer Network**	*More human, more premium*
Team	**Our People**	*"Team" stays acceptable in navigation*

Two words the brand does not own

Property Management and Property Appraisal. Both are searched for by name, branding them would cost enquiries, so they stay plain.

Note

Edition One used "Achieved" for Sold. That conflicted with an earlier confirmed direction to use Sold It. This draft applies Sold It. Flag if Achieved should stand instead.

Signage and print

Signboards

A board gets about two seconds of attention: one campaign word, one mark, one number.

- One campaign word only, never two on the same board: Own It, Preparing It, Sold It or Lease It.
- The mark sits on a Basalt headband, it reads further than a mark floating on sage and won’t disappear against a hedge.
- The agent is the smallest element: name, then number, at the foot. A face is optional, a legible phone number is not.
- Sage carries display type only, in Basalt (6.1:1). Nothing lighter than Basalt goes on sage.
- One arrow points, it doesn’t decorate: a single chevron, on the side it points to, sized to match the campaign word.



Cards, flyers and stationery

The same system, smaller. Nothing new invented at A4 or card size.

- Uncoated stock always: 350 gsm cards, 170 gsm flyers. Gloss undoes the chalky, natural palette.
- Stone is the paper. Specify a warm uncoated stock rather than printing a near-white flat.
- Request a rich black for any large Basalt area, a flat single black looks grey and patchy at size.
- No foil, spot gloss or bevel. Lift a piece with paper weight or a Basalt edge paint, never shine.
- One display size per piece: the campaign word largest, the address next, the agent smallest.



FRONT



BACK







Photography

Natural light, honest colour, architectural framing. The property is the hero, if a viewer notices the photography before the house, the shoot has failed.

Do

- Shoot early or late (long shadows and warm light suit the palette, midday sun blows out water).
- Square the verticals.
- Leave the room breathing (fewer props, nothing that won't be there on inspection day).
- Keep colour honest (grass is not emerald, the Broadwater is not turquoise).

Do not

Composite a sunset or sky that wasn't there.

Run a filter, vignette or heavy graduated wash.

Set type across the middle of a photograph.

Use a stock image of a house that is not the house, ever.

Type on photography: where Stone type must sit on an image, measure the scrim against the actual pixels behind it, to 4.5:1. A flat sage wash cannot deliver that at any opacity. Where possible, prefer a solid Basalt, Sage Grey or Stone panel beside the picture over type fighting the picture.

Website and digital

LOGO

Primary 150 px wide minimum, secondary 110 px, icon 32 px. Clear space on every side is the cap height of the O, including inside a header that’s already tight.

TYPE

Inter 300 to 600 for everything functional, Sinhala MN for display only, never below 18 px. Sinhala MN is Apple-only, a nominated substitute and CSS fallback are needed before launch (see Open decisions). Measure to about 65 characters.

COLOUR

No sage carries body copy, at any size or weight. Set text in Basalt, or on Basalt.

KNOWN FIX REQUIRED

The site currently ships Basalt as `#2D2D2D`. The master artwork is `#3A3A3A`. Change the token, not the artwork, and re-check any image scrim measured against the old value.

RETIRED NAME

`oneillgroup.com.au` is no longer the name. Remove it from markup, metadata, redirects and artwork wherever it still appears.

HOMEPAGE FLOW (CONFIRMED DIRECTION)

Hero > Value > Listings > About Us > CTA block (Sell with us / Our Agents) > News > Testimonial

Generous whitespace, paragraph-length testimonials, subtle scroll/hover motion, no generic star-rating widgets, no stock imagery.

Quick reference

Nothing new on this page, every line is a rule from an earlier one, in the order a piece of work usually breaks.

The mark and the field

01 One of the three supplied lockups, unmodified.

02 Clear space on all four sides is the cap height of the O.

03 At or above minimum size (40 mm / 150 px primary).

04 Colourway chosen for contrast against the ground behind it.

05 Sage Grey carrying the piece, not accenting it.

Type and words

01 Two families only: Sinhala MN for display, Inter for the rest.

02 One display size in the layout.

03 No type set in any sage, at any size.

04 Body copy at 4.5:1 against its ground, large text 3:1.

05 Australian English, no superlatives, no dash as punctuation.

Image and production

01 Natural light, squared verticals, honest colour, no replaced sky.

02 No type across the middle of a photograph.

03 Uncoated stock, Stone as the paper, rich black for large Basalt.

04 No gloss, foil, gradient, bevel or shadow anywhere.

05 oneillgroup.com.au does not appear anywhere.

Open decisions and contact

Four items are still open. Nothing above should be treated as final until these are resolved.

01 **Service area**

Northern Gold Coast, or Gold Coast-wide? Edition One says Northern Gold Coast, an earlier working direction said Gold Coast-wide. This affects audience copy, SEO and image selection.

02 **Sold copy**

This draft uses Sold It. Confirm this over Edition One's Achieved.

03 **Non-Apple display font**

Sinhala MN is Apple-only. A restrained high-contrast serif substitute needs to be nominated for Windows, Android and web fallback.

04 **App/social icon finish**

Stone on Basalt, or Sage Grey on Basalt. One has to win before launch.

O'NEILL PROPERTY

One name. One standard, every time.

FOR BRAND AND MARKETING ENQUIRIES

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